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HOW IT WORKS

If you want what we have to offer, and are willing to make the effort to get it, then you are ready to take certain steps. These are suggested only, but they are the principles that made our recovery possible.

1. We admitted that we were powerless over our addiction, that our lives had become unmanageable.
2. We came to believe that a power greater than ourselves could restore us to sanity.
3. We made a decision to turn our will and our lives over to the care of God as we understood Him.
4. We made a searching and fearless moral inventory of ourselves.
5. We admitted to God, to ourselves, and to another human being the exact nature of our wrongs.
6. We were entirely ready to have God remove all these defects of character.
7. We humbly asked Him to remove our shortcomings.
8. We made a list of all persons we had harmed, and became willing to make amends to them all.
9. We made direct amends to such people wherever possible, except when to do so would injure them or others.
10. We continued to take personal inventory, and when we were wrong promptly admitted it.
11. We sought through prayer and meditation to improve our conscious contact with God, as we understood Him, praying only for knowledge of His will for us, and the power to carry that out.
12. Having had a spiritual awakening as a result of those steps, we tried to carry this message to addicts and to practice these principles in all our affairs.

This sounds like a big order, and we can't do it all at once, we didn't become addicted in one day, so remember – EASY DOES IT.

There is one thing more than anything else that will defeat us in our recovery, this is an attitude of indifference or intolerance toward spiritual principles. Although there are no musts in N.A., there are three things that seem indispensable. These are, Honesty, Openmindedness, and Willingness to try. With these we are well on our way.

We feel that our approach to the problem of addiction is completely realistic, for the therapeutic value of one addict helping another is without parallel. We feel that our way is practical, for one addict can best understand and help another addict. We believe that the sooner we face our problems within our society, in everyday living, just that much faster do we become acceptable, responsible, and productive members of that society.

The only way to keep from getting or continuing a habit is not to take that first fix, pill or drink. If you are like us you know that one is too many and a thousand never enough. We put great emphasis on this for we know that when we use drugs in any form, or substitute one for another, we release our addiction all over again or create a new one.

The substitution of alcohol has caused a great many addicts to form a new addiction pattern, which in its progression brings as many problems as before. We seem to forget that alcohol is one of the oldest known drugs. It would appear that we are people with addictive personalities who are strongly susceptible to alcoholic addiction.

#4 A.

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...our desire to stop using was instigated by the second of two mental breakdowns, one involving drugs and one involving alcohol. We were tired of being rescued from the insanity that we called our lives, tired of our inability to live the life we truly wanted, tired of trying so desperately to fill that void within ourselves. This desperation drove us to NA, drove us to keep going to meetings, drove us to work our steps even though we didn't understand them.

... When I first came into the program of Narcotics Anonymous and I felt resentful at the suggestions some members made to me I expressed my resentments by arguing or by cold-shouldering the person who had tried to help us. Now my program simply acknowledges the fact that our drug-addict-self is having a temper tantrum over some idea it doesn't want to accept and I go right on with the conversation. We even ask the other person to tell us more, because now we know we need to hear it !

If we are serious about our recovery, we may want to fearlessly and thoroughly search our motives when we find ourselves in a position to hurt or help another. This honesty may cost us a few fantasies but it can help us a lot in reality. Many of us have come to believe that the forces of life know much more what our real needs are and will take care of us if undisturbed by self-will. This involves trust and faith in life itself.

Instead of ~~wanting~~ wanting our way, we are sick of it. We want another way.

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#4 A. (3)

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an attitude of humility WORK ONE OF the prime ingredients in the steps that in order to make the program work you have to be willing to do things that you might not like to do. OR WILLINGNESS

Eventually the fun and games variety of addiction is exhausted and we are left with our misery and our despair. Most of us do not expect to ever regain any sort of normal life. . As a living being we have beat ourselves into a corner by the actions we took in the grip of our addiction. Clean and sober we must leave our corner The steps give us the strength we will need to do this. First we give up the fight that we are not addicted and can do some drugs normally without compulsiveness. Then we learn to relate to a power greater than ourselves.

We have frequently gotten to a point where because of pain: I just can't go on any longer--intense pain: physicaaly, mentally, emotionally and spiritually. We can only stand it so long and then we must either GO or Grow.

After a week or so of this I get to where the promises

. We must be ready to go to any lengths to achieve sobriety. Some goals are reached only after we let go of some crucial reservation.

Sometimes, I try to sneak one past my head and decide it would be nice to change before the pain gets severe--all that does is make me ~~become~~ willing to consider change

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#4

A.

(4)

1 Nobody expects one of us to stumble into this program brimming with love, honesty or open-minded willingness. All that is required is that we try. If we give it our best go, it will work for us as it has worked for others.

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It's my old familiar ways and heads that makes life unbearable--not the universe. It's only when I can't stand my old ways any longer that we begin to change. Only under attack by severe and unyielding pain do the walls begin to crack.

Honesty plays a large part in ~~becoming~~ working ~~a~~ Program when we are honest about our feelings, likes & dislikes, wants, needs, is the ~~one~~ can other person ~~going to~~ people know in what how way they can help.

Willingness is especially important in the areas of practicing tolerance, patience and humility and honesty.

~~When we~~ can let go of ~~my~~ our false pride and look at my ~~life~~ our lives on a gut level - past all lies, dreams, and fallacies, ~~and admit that it can't live and really [illegible]~~ our need for change.

The hole in ~~the~~ our gut ~~will be fill~~ is filled with a new understanding of our place in the world and love for others. 3

1

After struggling through the daily burden of the monday on our backs we despair. ~~After~~ When we are beaten we are ready.

As we come clean and work our steps we will release ourselves from our chains, and be free people. 4

Sometimes the pain of working the 12-Steps is not as great as the pain of not working them, so we work the 12-Steps.

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#4 A.

5

None of these steps work by magic. You don't say the words of the steps like a stage magician pulling rabbits out of a hat. They work when they are lived.

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battle to so ~~straight~~ clear. ③ ~~We body, I was told as I would be easy.~~

We would only recommend that you read this book and attend meetings of N.A. and see for yourself if the program might have something to offer you. ⑤ It's not where you're at that counts but where you're going.

We are trying to achieve adequacy not perfection. adequate adequacy can be achieved but perfection can not by humans. ⑥

THIS PROGRAM IS SIMPLE. BUT NO ONE EVER SAID IT was easy. #7

③

We can reach and awaken the force for life within the ~~addict~~ OURSELVES, it can do anything, ② even give ~~an addict~~ us a new life. ⑧

Recovery is a contact process. ⑨

Surrender ⑩

. The breakdown of old ideas and old ways seems to be beyond my conscious control. It sort of seems things are going to change when they're going to change--if I can accept what's going on and relax and enjoy as much of the ride as possible then the whole thing becomes okay--sort of. Even when it's so bad that I can't stand it.

The only control of the situation I seem to have is a choice of forward or self-destruct.

What areas I change in and how fast I change--in what order--all seem ~~(to me)~~ to be predetermined by my very nature.

It's true I have to just desire something and then to follow the necessary path.

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#4

B. Step one

(6)

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Powerless

.- Yeah, we just remember the powerlessness that we felt using drugs. As it says, it was calling me, to a bar, to a party, to walk down the street, you gotta get loaded. Before we go to get loaded, you gotta get loaded. We never felt like human beings, I never felt like I was able to make a mistake, to be o.k. with myself. That last sentence tells us that it's o.k.; I got a chance to become a human being to start all over agin. We have

and the longer we stayed in it, there was no happiness in my life at all, our lives

We I had to get to the point where I realized that my will power wasn't going to pull me through anymore. I used my will power a lot, I had a strong will power, and a lot of times I knew when I'd gotten really bad with drugs, I could say, 'o.k., I have to get my act together now', and just by sheer will power alone, get clean just go straight for awhile, and get my head together and do it. It had to be to the point where that wasn't working anymore, I just couldn't do it. Until then, it had just been my own strength that got me through, but at that point, I knew my own strength just wasn't enough.

Step 1

(24)

Everything we've ever tried has failed anyway--so what have we got to lose? Counselors, psychiatrists, hospitals, lovers, new towns, new jobs--we've tried everything to control our using or to stop using. None of our efforts got us anywhere in the long run.

4-B-1 For a day, a week or a month perhaps; but sooner or later we take that first ~~pill, fix or drink~~ and we're gone again--worse than ever.

When we give up--quit struggling--surrender, completely and unconditionally--then and only then can we be helped to recover from the disease of drug addiction.

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How it works

THE TWELVE STEPS OF NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS

As Practiced by One Member

Step #1, I had to affirm that I am powerless, and I had to go to meetings and hear people talking about it.

Am I sure I want to stop using drugs? Do I understand and believe that I have no real, long term control over drugs? Do I recognize that in the long run I don't use drugs--they use me? Do I fully accept the fact that every attempt on my part to taper off or stop using or to control my using has failed? Do I know in my heart that drugs have the power to change me into something I don't want to be; a liar, a thief, a schemer? Do I admit to myself that every time I've been in trouble; everytime I hurt someone intentionally, I was either loaded or trying to get loaded? Do I know in my guts that I fail to do the good things I start out to do and wind up doing the bad things I don't want to do because of the way I use drugs?

If I can let go of my false pride and look at my life on a gut level--past all the lies, dreams, and fantasies--and admit that it's all true and really feel it, then I'm at Step One of the Narcotics Anonymous program which is...

"We admitted we were powerless over drugs, that our lives had become unmanageable."

If we can cut through all the nonsense we've been telling ourselves to make ourselves feel good--and admit to ourselves that we are powerless over drugs and that we have made a mess of our lives--we have a chance. Strange as it may seem, the only help for addicts of our type comes only when we are able to admit complete defeat--utter failure. For people like us, it has to be a whole new ballgame.

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#4 B. Step one

(8)

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Then I started to realize that through being completely defeated, that I did have a chance, that it did of a sudden became kind of different that it was going to end up going to jail. End up dying, end up back in the nut house permanently.

Step 1

85

This question is one that can only be answered by yourself. If you are an addict and refused to admit it, it doesn't matter who or how many other people are aware of your disease, because before any progress can be made toward recovery, you must first admit and accept the fact that you are powerless over drugs.

. Step one maans that we don't have to make excuses for the way we are and that is a great freedom. Surrender means not having to fight anymore.

. It takes a while to realize how unmanageableour lives had become for some of us. for others this is about the only thing that we can be sure of.

In a way a gamblers and like the odds againist us. This was the way that It was when used drugs.

This is the way we recover

P.- hit the bottom, It's like the slide has stopped, with the admission of complete defeat, You've stopped right there, the only way to go now is up. The positive things start happening, 're able to stop.

To admit powerlessness, it got so bad to a point where couldn't take anymore pain, self-punishment, and What promised, to me, better than anything in the world, was pain might not get any better, It might stay that way but it's not gonna get any worse than it's been over the last few years, and that's when my foundation started, just so torn up inside, just couldn't take anymore pain.

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#4 weB, Step One (9)

When A.-- ~~I~~ came into the program, ~~I~~ heard that step being read and talked about; for ~~myself~~, it was hope, that's the hope they were talking about. ~~I~~ admitted to someone, finally, 'cause ~~I~~ kept it all in and stuff. ~~I admitted to my wife,~~ in fits of insanity, that ~~I~~ couldn't do it ~~myself,~~ and that's the hope. The obsession's still there, but there's a hope that it's going to end, and that it's O.K.

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We were going out of control while high, unpredictable, and dangerous. Drugs horribly destroyed peace of mind and filled with self-hatred, anger, remorse, self-pity and guilt... the very same things we were looking to escape.

B-1 → [~~I~~ completely powerless over any drug whether it be alcohol or any other drug that will alter my mood or way of thinking or outlook on life.

W~~E~~ HAD TO ACCEPT CONDITIONS THAT WE WERE POWERLESS OVER, and change what we could . We could not change any one or any thing but our selves, in the final analyisis. WE found we had to make a surrender to life on lifes terms or surely be snuffed by the drugs , by our addiction, or by society.

It al. begins with that first admission, ~~and that first white chip.~~ From that point forward each addict is reminded that a day clean is a day won and any failure is only a temporary set-back rather than a link in an unbreakable chain.

When we give up--quit struggling--surrender, completely and unconditionally--then and only then can we be helped to recover from the disease of drug addiction.

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~~Strange as it may seem, the only help for addicts of our type comes only when we are able to admit complete defeat--~~ utter failure. For people like us, it has to be a whole new ball-game.

#4 B. Step one

Where is ~~this~~ help? How ~~do~~ I get it? What ~~is~~ it? ~~You go~~ to a meeting of Narcotics Anonymous. ~~Take~~ a look around. If you're the kind of drug user who lives in the streets trying to find something to bang into your arm from day to day, you are inclined to be skeptical and not overly trusting. ~~You~~ need proof. In that N.A. meeting is your proof. There you ~~will find~~ people like yourself with the same or worse patterns of drug dependency and failure and they are clean ~~and sober~~. ~~There is your~~ proof. They ~~can smile~~. ~~Their~~ eyes are clear. ~~They seem to~~ care for each other. They will probably introduce themselves to you and try to make ~~you~~ feel welcome. As ~~the~~ meeting progresses ~~you will~~ hear a little bit about them from their own lips.

~~Am I sure I want to stop using drugs?~~ Do I understand and believe that I have no real, ~~long term~~ control over drugs? Do I recognize that ~~in the long run~~ I don't use drugs--they use me? ~~Do I~~ fully accept the fact that every attempt ~~on my part to taper off or stop using or~~ to control my using has failed? ~~Do I~~ know in ~~my~~ heart that drugs have the power to change me into something ~~I~~ don't want to be;

~~We devalue~~ ourselves in our own eyes. We of all people have surely had enough of self-destruction. We want first to learn, then to do the things that will help us transform into self affirming people. ~~We then hit bottom.~~

We ~~are~~ searching for an answer. Looking for a way out. Things don't seem to be able to get any worse. We reach ~~out~~ and there's an answer.

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#4 B Step one (11)

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Until we took step 1 completely ~~Until we completed step 1~~, we were caught in resentations. We felt different, ~~apart from~~ Across working step 1 we affirm our surrender to the people of N.A. and only then do we over come the alienation of being a drug addict: From apart from we become a part of.

We have an incurable, progressive, terminal disease called drug addiction. It doesn't matter whether we "just take a few pills", fix eight times a day, suck on a pipe or drink bottles of cough remedy behind drug stores or have one tranquilizer with our first martini of each day--we have certain things in common no matter what kind or degree of addict we are.

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OURSELVES

End of step one

#4 B. Step two (12)

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If you can accept the fact that a large number of drug dependent people were, like yourself, unable to control their own lives and that they have, through Narcotics Anonymous, found a way to live safe and sober, you have only to believe what you see and experience to complete Step 2.

N. A. has many members. Their Power--collectively, is certainly greater than that of any individual member. Surely, you realize that if your car gets stuck in the mud, and you can't get it out by yourself, you get help in the form of many hands or a large machine. What is impossible for one alone is often light work for many. So then, the many are a greater power than the one alone. You don't have to be religious to accept the idea of a power greater than yourself. Just take a look around with an open mind and you will see a positive power all around N.A. Call it love, call it harmony, call it peace, call it cleanness and soberness, call it good or call it God. It doesn't matter now what you call it. What matters is that you want to get well and happy and by looking and listening as openly as you can, you find that N.A. seems to have the Power to get people well and happy.

Thus thi king, I have affirmed the desire to stay clean and sober in spite of the dilema, no matter how large it may seem. Also, I have affirmed my surrender to you people of N.A. and only then do I over come the alienation of being a drug addict.

You may be one of us who says, "I need help with my drug problem and I can see that N.A. has that alright; but that Second Step says this power greater than ourselves will "restore us to sanity" and I'm not crazy. I just can't handle drugs."
Many of us started out with that attitude.

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#4

B. Step two

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... The higher power we see in Narcotics Anonymous is a lot like this. We begin by simply admitting to the possibility of a power greater than ourselves. We discover that power in our lives from the very beginning of our lives in the program. Many fortunate things will occur mysteriously. We ~~can only accept them~~ but there are ~~no~~ accidents. Surely, we realize that if our car gets stuck in the mud, and we can't get it out by ourselves, we get help in the form of many hands or a large machine ~~power to haul it out. Logically, that honesty may cost us a few fantasies but it can help us a lot in reality.~~ Many of us have come to believe that the forces of life know much more what our real needs are and will take care of us if undisturbed by self-will. This involves trust and faith in life itself.

Is there really any madness in the universe or are there only similar states of painful confusion springing from various disorders of body and soul.

WE HAD NO TROUBLE ADMITTING THAT ~~DRUGS~~ HAD BECOME A DESTRUCTIVE POWER ADDICTION

GREATER THAN OURSELVES. IT LOGICALLY FOLLOWS THAT THERE CAN ALSO BE A CONSTUCTIVE POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVE

(21)

WHEN the drugs are washed from our bodies through daily abstinence and our minds begin to clear from the effects of our drug of choice, a miracle takes place. We come to understand that our recoveries are a gift from a power greater than ourselves.

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13 B

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Sanity is like having our priorities in order. We don't use drugs we go to meetings; and using the N.A. program, we rely on God to provide what we need on a daily basis. We have been restored to sanity as far as the compulsion to use drugs is concerned.

Keeping a watchful eye on our daily H.A.L.T.S. maintenance, we can get some food when Hungry; call someone in N.A. on the phone when Angry and Lonely; get some rest when Tired; and go to an N.A. meeting when taking ourselves too serious.

The important thing to remember as the urge to use drugs occurs is the fact that just because the mind is asking for drugs, it doesn't mean the body is. We are so into denial and over-controlling our emotions that the occassion thought of drugs may be the only way our mind knows to get our attention. The mind signals drugs when the body may be actually asking for vitamins, food, rest or companionship. So we what our H.A.L.T.S. maintenance daily. The demand for drugs is usually short lived and passes quickly. Any reoccurring, long term thought about using drugs could indicate the need to do inventory and talk to another member of N.A.

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#4 B. Step Two

(14)

There is a spirit that has guided all living things. Call it God, Reason, the Infinite, Muhamad, Christ or whatever you like. If you chose call it nothing at all but find it and learn to benefit from it's power and you will gain a new life, free from drugs and the pain their use has caused us.

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We have begun to see only recently how much my Higher Power has to offer to me. Sobriety and clean living are only the beginning the my new life. I am being given a gift of life without fear, and insecurity.

I wasn't using, but I had little ~~but service to other addicts~~ in its place. I gradually began to find some order in the universe, and accepted that "somebody" was supplying me with a conscience I had never had before, and was somehow giving me the power to overcome the compulsion to use. It sure as hell wasn't me. I wanted to get high so bad it was ridiculous, but knew that I could be of no use to anyone

Belief is the beginning. ~~Step one establishes us as members and removes the need to explain our short comings.~~ Step two begins to give us the power to overcome our compulsion. It is helpful to stop at this point and go over our thinking in this and all respects respect. We should not take the chance that our understanding of a power greater than ourselves is sufficient at this point.

Your power can be the group itself. It can ~~be traditions or~~ follow a religious tradition. The only thing we want to emphasize is that you should feel comfortable with your higher power and be able to make the statement that it cares about you.

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#4 B. Step two

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So, we have this disease: Progressive, incurable, terminal. And the most amazing single fact about the disease is that we went out and bought it on the time plan! That is insane. Think about that. You, I, everyone you meet in N.A., the junkie snatching purses on the street, the sweet ladies hitting two or three different doctors for their perfectly legal prescriptions. All of us have this one thing in common--we buy the disease that kills us and, one way or another, we usually pay for it with blood, sweat and tears and we continue to pay for it a balloon at a time or a few pills at a time or a bottle at a time until the day we die. That is at least part of the insanity of drug addiction. The price may seem worse for the junkie girl who prostitutes herself for her fix than it is for the wealthy woman who merely lies to her doctor but ultimately, both pay with their lives. Ask yourself this question: Do I believe that it would be insane to walk up to someone and say "Would you please sell me my own death--on the time plan?" Or--"May I please have a heart attack or a fatal accident?" If you can agree that this would be an insane thing comparable to giving yourself an injection of deadly poison, only slower, you should have no trouble with the Second Step.

The second step is in all likeihood the second most important ~~most important thing~~ that has to happen for us to acheive any sort of ongoingnrecaxary from our disease. The 1st Step well taken leaves us at a place where we need to come to believe in something that can help us with our lack of power and sense of hopelessness. Belief becomes the most important thing for us to work on. We have im all probability some type of belief and unless we examine it some and seek to improve it to where it fits the facts better, it may prove to be insufficient to give us recovery. Certainly our belief did'nt do too much to help us with our active addiction in the past, If we want ~~more~~ better results we should look for what's been working and what has failed us , seperate them and discard that which doesnot work. Our belief has usually come to us at an early age from members of a family that has at least one member who has a disease with definite traits of family illness We may or may not have a

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#4 B. step two

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Most addicts have strong feelings about their higher power and vigorously defend their right to their own understanding. This is fine and well but make sure you've at least thought it over privately and perhaps talked about it with some trusted friend.

The strength to move into action comes from our higher power however we may understand him. Asking for help in specific terms usually precedes getting that help. maybe it helps open the gates of our hearts and be ready to receive the help we need.

We need to accept this step fully to start our road to recovery.

When our belief has grown to some point of comfort, we are ready to take the third ste-

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#4 B. Step 3

17

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All the time you've been an addict, your will, your life itself has been controlled by drugs. Your choices have always been determined by drugs. You've had to be where you could get them. You've had to be nice to whoever had them. You had to have the money to obtain them: in the case of the illegal drugs--quite a lot of money. Then, when you get your drugs and the search is over for a few hours or a few days you eat, drink, inhale or inject your drug. Then your mind, your body, your soul--your total being is dominated by that drug. For a while, it may be pleasurable, at least in the early stages of addiction but ultimately, the affect begins to wear off and the drug begins to show its other side. One of the strange facts about drugs is that the higher they get us when they come on, the lower they bring us when we're coming down. When our nerves begin jangling like a fire alarm, we have two choices. We can live through a period of discomfort or we can take more drugs. For an addict, at some point in their career, there is no longer a choice. We get more drugs. Can you see that whether you steal these drugs or buy them you are being controlled by them? Whether you are under the influence of drugs, trying to find drugs or leaving town because of something you did in your effort to stay loaded, your actions, your will and your very life are being directly controlled by drugs.

Our way did not work. So we are going to try another way. We are going to try to let God, as we understand Him care for and direct our lives.

In the Third Step we snatch our life away from drugs and put it where it belongs. *1

This is a giant step. But anyone can take it. You don't have to be religious. ~~You don't have to believe in God~~. You have only to believe what you see with your own eyes in the transformed lives of N.A. members and have a desire to ~~get well~~ stay clean. That's all it takes--an open mind. If the word "God" bothers you--substitute recovery or Good or love or N.A. or peace--anything positive, just so you mean it.

None of these steps work by magic. You don't say the words of the steps like a stage magician pulling rabbits out of a hat. They work when they are lived. But they are easier to live by than the law of the needle or the law of the pill or the law of the bottle. If you want to ~~get well~~ stay clean, if you are willing to do the few simple things ~~necessary to get well~~, if you will be honest with yourself in this endeavour; it is guaranteed that you will ~~get well~~ recover.

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Start THIS Step ~~three~~ requires a basis in belief and if this #1
or any step gives you trouble, go back to the one before it.
Generally, if we are fearless and through enough, we can find
something that we have left out and ~~thereby~~ having then completed
that step we are ready to go on to the next one. Obviously
we can't turn our lives and will over to the care of a God we
don't believe in or a God we don't trust, ~~feel~~ to restore us to sanity.

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#4 B. Step three

(18)

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Nobody expects one of us to stumble into this program brimming with love, honesty or open-minded willingness. All that is required is that we try. If we give it our best go, it will work for us as it has worked for others. The Third Step does not say "We turned our will and our lives over to the care of God", it says "We made a decision to turn our will and our lives over to the care of God as we understood Him." We made a decision. Drugs did not make that decision. Our wife, our probation officer did not make that decision. We did. This is the first action we take in this program. For the first time, we make a decision for ourselves. If you understand God to be simply whatever keeps the rest of us clean and sober that's fine. Ask that power to take care of you as it cares for us--even if it makes you feel stupid. Go off by yourself and say silently, "God, I've made a mess of my live. I can't solve my problems so I'm asking you if you'll please take care of me and show me how to live a good, happy life."

If you honestly try it, it will work. Many of us start our day with that or a similar plea, ~~every day~~. "Thy will be done." #2

In this Third Step, we simply recognize that there is a force for good in the world and we cooperate with that force. We let good things happen to us. Every action we've ever taken in regards to drugs was taken in an effort to get comfortable. And it didn't work. Our way did not work. So we are going to try another way. We are going to try to let God, as we understand Him care for and direct our lives.

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#2

The tension of letting go and letting God sometimes manifests itself in the personality of an addict. It is the tension of letting go of old ideas and things that don't work anymore and letting God help us develop what works here and now. We can adjust this tension in our personality daily by using the N.A. program.

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#4 - B, Step three

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If we have come this far in the N.A. program, we have already noticed some change in our lives. Of course, the change is probably not as fast nor as dramatic as we could wish. We turned to drugs in the first place because we were people who wanted instant happiness or instant comfort and the drugs seemed, for a time, to provide it. We may be impatient for change. Impatience may be one of our life problems. Many of us expect that as soon as we stop taking drugs, all of our other troubles are going to disappear. If you have been around long enough to get through the first three steps, you have probably discovered this isn't so. There are still bills to be paid, people to get along with or without, fears and ills to be dealt with. In fact, now that we are facing life without a periodic anesthetic, these life problems may seem at first to be more difficult and painful than ever. They can appear to be impossible and overwhelming. That's why we have Step Four.

We suddenly have the right to discontinue our old ways and try new ways. We surrender our lives and our wills to the care of a power greater than our selvesand become an part of that higher power. We must stop fighting loosing battles in order to win the battles we do fight.

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#4 B. Step 3

(20)

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~~This is why the~~ third step is so important to us. ~~It is the decision to turn our will and lives over to the care of our higher power~~, as we use this step, the insanity of daily living evaporates.

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The reliance in ~~a higher power~~ God is possible because we no longer have a ~~chemical~~ drug separating our consciousness from higher power consciousness.

Drugs ~~Chemicals~~ act as a roadblock to higher power consciousness, ~~this~~ causing the hopeless and helpless feeling of inad quacy most ~~using drug~~ addicts experience, ~~as a result of this separation~~.

~~We are going to feel inadequate as long as there is a mood changing or mind altering chemical~~ drug in our body; it is the result of long term drug usage though the eventual remorse can occur ~~at any stage in the disease~~.

~~The cloudy~~ Inadequacy leaves when we stop using ~~drugs~~ because we no longer have a ~~chemical~~ drug shutting us off from the sunlight of the higher power.

With the reliance in a higher power, we become a part of the whole design for living free, ~~from chemical addiction~~ drugs. The feelings of hopelessness and helplessness begin to disappear.

Now we have natural highs, and the occassional lows are not as heavy as before our conscious contact with ~~higher power~~ God.

In ~~the~~ NA ~~recovery program~~, these highs and lows of living clean eventually even up and balance themselves into a casual, easy does it, live and let live, daily enjoyment of life straight.

And, for this clean living, we maybe eternally grateful.

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to our higher power.

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~~So we come to believe in A God and we ask~~

~~just needed~~

to resto~~[illegible]~~

~~[illegible] God had always~~

to have a working ~~[illegible]~~ ~~that this~~ God was

such a ~~good friend we gave him our will and life to take care of~~

~~He gave us back a tender loving care of our once wreaked life~~

es.

#4 B. 4th Step (1)

Step Four is here to help us see exactly where our problems are and to measure our strengths and weaknesses.

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NOP Let's face it. When we were using we weren't very honest with ourselves. If we were, we wouldn't have been able to live with our addiction. We are finally beginning to become honest when we admit drugs have us whipped and that we need help--but it took us a long time to get down to where we could admit we were whipped and we're probably not going to become well physically, spiritually, mentally or emotionally overnight. Step Four is going to help us toward recovery more than we can imagine. Ask anyone who has some time on the program and who has the kind of life you want for yourself. Almost without exception, they will tell you that the Fourth Step was a turning point in their lives. Most of us were surprised to find that we had some good points in our moral inventory!

Some people make the mistake of approaching the Fourth Step as if it were a confession of how horrible they are--what a bad person they have been. This is not the purpose of the Fourth Step. We are trying to free ourselves of living in old, useless patterns. We take the Fourth Step to gain the necessary strength and insight to enable us to grow in this new way of life. A binge of emotional sorrow over real and imagined wrongs will not help us. In fact, it could be quite harmful. ~~We want to look at what we have done and neglected~~ or

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#4 - to do Step 4 lives. but our purpose is to be rid of guilt--not to wallow in it! To be done with the past, not to cling to it. We want to look it in the face and see it for what it was--and then release it so that we can live in today. The past, for most of us, has been a ghost in the closet. We have been afraid to open that closet for fear of what that ghost may do to us. (68)

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#4 B. 4th Step

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The way to write an inventory is to write it! Thinking about inventory, talking about it (one-on-one or at meetings), theorizing about it, will not get it written. Sit down with a notebook, pray, pick up your pen and start writing!

~~Remember that~~ you don't have to do this alone. Your will and your life are now in the hands of the Source of all strength - tap into this Source! Writing a thorough and honest inventory looks impossible to most of us. This may be because it is - if we're operating on our own "power". Take a few quiet moments each time before you write and pray for "the power to carry it out."

Don't write your inventory with a particular person in mind to read it to. If you do that you may wind up "slanting" what you write in order to please them. Besides, life is unmanageable, and you can't know for sure to whom you'll read it anyway. Only time will tell, and the Fifth Step will take care of itself. You're not there yet and you don't have to worry about it. Stay here in the Now - you're on Step Four, and that's all.

A Fourth Step takes the confusion out of our minds and puts it on paper where we can look at it.

You may approach it in any number of ways. It is advisable that before you do, you go over the first three steps with your sponsor. Be comfortable with your understanding of these steps. Allow yourself the privilege of feeling good about what you are doing. Don't allow yourself to be driven as you were driven for so long by drugs. Remember that one of our mottoes is "Easy Does It". We have been crashing around for a long time and it's gotten us nowhere. Now we're going to take it easy and not let things frighten us.

If you possibly can, get off by yourself, away from the daily pressures to do this.

So, go over the first three steps and then, with pen and paper, begin your inventory. If ~~they~~ the word moral bothers you, call it your positive/negative inventory, or your good/bad inventory. All you're trying to do is to find out which things about yourself you want to change. If you were a grocer, you would not hesitate to separate the rotten fruit from the good fruit in your store and throw the rotten fruit away. ~~Well, there is rotten fruit lying side by side with good fruit in your heart and~~ the N.A. program has this Fourth Step to help you see which is which.

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*2

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we may examine in depth our relationships to people, places and things; and ask ourselves what we have demanded of these relationships. Often the answers will show that we are placing unreasonable demands on reality. Often we find we are demanding people not be who they are, say what they just said or do what they are doing.

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#4 B. Step 4 (3)

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It is important to remember where we came from if we don't want to return. ~~more years before I knew I needed help.~~ We had to go through what we went through, to get where we are

fit the individual

A basic rule of thumb is that you can write too little, but you can never write too much. Just write and write, until your brain is empty. Those things that you think about while not sleeping are usually inventory material.

as we realize how little of value ~~[illegible]~~ we have to lose and how much better off we will be without our defects, ~~[illegible]~~ we will plunge into this step without reservation.

by listing ~~The first step is~~ removeing these thorns in our sides ~~to be aware~~ them on paper. The drug addict sits down with paper and pen and prays for god to help him in this and to reveal the defects that are causing pian and suffering. ~~to himself~~ and those virtues that have lent happiness and given peace, ~~to himself~~.

We pray for the courage to be fearless and throrough that this inventory may help us to get our lifes in order ~~so we can better help others~~. When we pray and take action it almost invariably goes well for us.

*2 Write down your fears, your resentments, your guilts. ~~Watch~~ or ~~We may examine indepth our relationships to people, places and things.~~

Most of us have found that we were neither so terrible nor so wonderful as we supposed. Ultimately we are just human, with pretty much the same fears and longings and troubles and so on as everyone else. One of the greatest benefits of the N.A. program is discovering that we need never be alone again. Others have felt as we have felt. Others have failed where we have failed and they are ~~there~~ here now in the strength of the fellowship, ready and eager to help us.

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This Fourth Step can be a wonderful adventure, ~~The fourth step involves~~ reviewing our past performance and our present behavior to see what we want to keep and what we want to be rid of. It seems that this step has the reputation of being a bugaboo. In Really it is quite simple.

#4 B, Step Four

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It is not expected that we are going to do it perfectly right away. If we were perfect, we would not be human. The important thing is that we do our best. We use the tools available to us. Get into action--get started and let it flow.

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#4

B. Step 5

(1)

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STEP FIVE: Admitted to God, ourselves, and to another human being the exact nature of our wrongs.

After taking the fourth step, by taking our personel inventory, we have to deal with what we have found. We have to decide first what ~~are~~ our defects are and then what to do with them. If we choose to keep these defects inside of us it could lead to us using again. People might tell you that you look and sound good but if you ~~don't~~ may not feel it ~~your nowhere~~. You might look good from the outside, as far as your appearence and you might sound real confident and strong when you talk, but if you don't feel good deep down inside your heart, you wont grow. So the fifth step allows us to release some of this frustration hurt and anger.

For years we've avoided seeing ourselves as we are. We were ashamed of ourselves and we did what we could to hide our shame from God, ourselves and the rest of the ~~people~~ world. Now we've got this shameful past trapped on paper and we can sweep it out of our lives by admitting it. We don't want to make the mistake of writing it all down and then shoving it in a drawer somewhere. [redacted]t

Your higher power will be with you when you do this and your admissions will help free you fromthe old ways of fear. Before we take this step we live in fear that if we reveal ourselves as we really are, then we'll be rejected and lose the friendships that have filled our lives. Humans have much more in common with each other than they suppose and we can consciously experience this oneness if we can come out of hiding a little bit.

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In taking this step we have to learn to accept ourselves. By learning to accept ourselves we become more a part of the program.

B. Step 5

(2)

Often fear or pride will hold us back, but only in taking this step are we free to grow. In trying to deal with these defects alone, we may find that it is to much to handle. We will find by admitting to another person that things are not as bad as we sometimes think they are. Sometimes we feel that noone else could ever relate or even begin to understand some of the horrible things we have done, but often we will find that we are not alone. Another person may help us understand that we can change if we really want to. Talking to a recovering addict will give us the courage we need to become a stronger person. Obtaining sobriety is hard work but if we stick it out it will get better.

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We must of course be careful about who we take this Fifth Step with, to who we tell the truth about our pasts. Many of us have taken our Fifth Step with a total stranger-- a priest or minister or a counselor. Some of us have gone to another town and some of us take it with our sponsor or someone else we select near at hand. The important thing here is that we choose someone with whom we can be honest and open; that we hold nothing back. To be certain, as time goes by, we will remember things that we did not include in our Fourth Step. The point is that we disclose all that we do remember, all that we have written. As we do this, most of us feel our burden lighten. It is crucial that we take this Step with an understanding person. Whoever you select, make certain they know what you are doing and why you are doing it. You will be amazed at how willing most people are to help. It is one of the great benefits of this program that we are able, once again, to let people into our lives as we use the tools of the program to "break down the walls of our own loneliness."

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Once you have taken this Step, you are practically certain to feel lightened and refreshed. It is such a relief to be rid of the burden of all those "secrets." We share the load and it becomes immeasurably lighter.

#4

B. Step 5

N.A. WSC-LC

(3)

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Only by taking this step can we set ourselves in the path of true sobriety. It will clean our heads of all the garbage which we have collected in the years of our addiction. It will show us humility and bring us in touch with true honesty.

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Beware of half-stepping, by holding onto old images, this will hold us back from starting a new life. Maybe we did already take a 5th step but we really didn't get honest and hung onto some things. Then we are doing the same thing we did when we were using, first we felt the hurt and then covered it up with drugs. By half stepping we run the risk of repeating our old pattern and getting high again.

Alot of times we try to look good in front of other people, but deep down inside we are really afraid of who we are and where we came from. We try to hold onto these images in order to make people believe that we are something other than ourselves. In suppressing our true feeling and holding onto these false images it will stop us in getting in touch with true reality. People who have held back onto these old ways find that only after letting go can we find true serenity.

Once we begin and are willing to forgive ourselves we can also begin to forgive others and begin to let go of all resentments in order that we may receive inner peace.

In order to grow we must remember that we are the most important person to ourselves and not worry about the opinion of other people. To be able to start a new and true beginning in life we must humble ourselves and become honest.

In examining ourselves as honestly as possible and in discussing our past with another human being as honestly as possible--it is probably that we have discovered some things about ourselves that we don't like. Perhaps we call these things character defects, perhaps we call them shortcomings or moral blind spots Whatever we call them, we recognize that they must change if we are to grow. And we recognize that we ourselves cannot, of ourselves, change them.

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#4 B. Step Six (1)

Let us go back to the First Step for a minute. Remember that we had to surrender completely to obtain relief. We had to admit we were whipped. This Sixth Step is the same situation. We can't do it ourselves--but we know that God as we understand Him can do it for us, if we really want Him to.

Do we really want to be rid of our resentments, our angers, our fears? All our resentments? Do we really understand that they are a deadly poison in the heart of an addict?

Lettin. go of character defects should be done with love. Fear and hate cannot give us new lives. We should approach old defects in patience and understanding for they have served us well in days past. They have kept us from situations we couldn't handle before we got the program and a new source of power. In most cases we can be grateful that our defects are not more pronounced or of a more harmful nature. Whenwe can see how they fit in our lives before the program and accept them, we can let go more completely and get on with our new life.

Many of us cling to our fears and doubts and self-loathing or hatred of others because there is a certain distorted security in familiar pain. It seems safer to hold on to the old pain than to let go of it for the unknown.

Here, once again, we look to those N.A. people who have the kind of life we want for ourselves. We ask them--"Did you let go?" And here, once again, almost without exception the answer is, "Yes, to the uttermost of my ability."

B. Step 6

Step 6 becoming entirly ready to have God remove all these defect of characrtor. God really has removed alot of our more glaring defects ,most gracefully and mercifully too. When we are taking step six it is important to remember that we are too human ang should not place great expectations on our selves. We should, however, remember that we are not kidding when we say entirly readyto have all these defect removed. This is a step of willingness and either we are willing or we are not. That is the spiritual principle aof step six ,willingness. It is as if t o say that we are now willing to moove along spiritual lines toward a destination we can not imagion ,and strive to live life free from all our defects of charactor. Being human we will of couse fall short. We will still get mad from time to time,especially if we are too hungery, lonely or tired. We will still feel our Lust , self pity , wrath, envy , pride, vainity, scrulty, greed, selfishness and ego centricity comming back prerhaps in differnt and new forms. We may feel dishonesty creep in and tell us that these new forms are all right ,that we may hold on willfully to them. The six step and or experiense show us that this form of self deseption only suceedes in covering our real motives which invariably are that we are trying to get what we want our of our lives. That we arestill trying to manage our unmanagable lives and run the show,and take our will back from God's grace.

WILLINGNESS is what we should strive for instep 6 the tools we use to make our willingness keen are prayer ,and practice and another is the priorities . How sincerly we will beable to work atep six will all so be preportionalto our desire to cange. We often will feel that we will never be ready to have all our defacet removed but we ought to remember that the main point is that we are on a journy and that the destination isnt what matters,. what matters is that we are in a state of stiving to better ourself so that we may better serve God and our fellows. For we are doomed if we dont stive for a better way and lifted up when we surrender to the simple instuctions that the program offers us as away to a new way of life.

Without defects life is ever new sensational and deeply wonderful. We can earnestly urge that we know that we are growing when we make new mistakes rather than the same old stituations cropping up again and again.

Life with the defects may cause perpetual frustration we may relapse ,we will at anyrate be in for an uncomfortable time of bearly getting by and dry runs frquently.

WE sugest that we decide where our priorities lye ,that we envision life free from the defects, that we at the very least recogniz when our life is going sour that it is because of our defects and that it isnt the person place, or thing that is the cause of our problem. It is our defects. WE should at least accept personal responsibility for our problems.

All that is required in the Sixth Step is the honest willingness to let go of those things about yourself that you have already decided you wished to part company with--the fears and doubts of that other life.

#4 B. Step 7 (1)

Having decided we want God, as we understand Him to believe us of the useless or destructive aspects of our personalities we arrive at the Seventh Step:

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We have all spent much of our lives being anything but humble. We have been humiliated by many of the things that happen to us while using drugs--but most of us avoided true humility until we took N.A.'s First Step. Then again in the Third Step we ask God to direct our will and our lives. And now in the Seventh Step we humbly ask Him to remove our shortcomings.

The key of this step is an understanding of the word humility. Humility is as much a part of staying ~~sober~~ clean as food and water are to staying alive. As we struggled along in our addiction we devoted our energy towards satisfying our material needs. We always had to have a satisfaction of our basic desires such as prestige and power. We never thought of spiritual growth or asking a Higher Power for direction. We were the Higher Power.

We could handle the trials and tribulations of life all by ourselves. It wasn't until we made a real mess of our lives that we realized that we couldn't do it alone. By admitting that we were powerless over our addiction and reaching out for help, we achieved our first glimpse of humility.

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If the defects we have discovered are real and we have a chance to be rid of them surely we will experience a sense of high adventure at this point. Some will want ot get on their knees for this step. Some will get ~~physical out in a~~ quiet ~~way~~ or put forth a great mantal effort to show intent willingness. The word humble applies because we approach this power greater than ourselves to ask for the most wonderous gift of the

program; the freedom to live without the limitations of our past ways. However we want to handle it, we go all the way. Think of what we have to lose. As soon as we feel ourselves willing, go ahead and ask God to remove the shortcomings!

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When we were in our addiction our spiritual and emotional growth came to a halt. We did not mature and grow like a normal person. Now that we are clean there are many situations that arise in our daily lives that are difficult to understand. By practicing the virtue of humility and reaching out and asking for help we can get through even the toughest of times. I can't we can. It is not a sign of weakness, it is a sign of growth.

We have to realize that people can give us direction and that our way of thinking is not the only way. We must puncture that ego and realize we have much work to do. When someone points out a shortcoming, our first reaction is one of defensiveness. If we really want to grow we will take a good look at what is pointed out. We must realize we are not perfect and there are things we must change.

The main objective of step seven is to get out of ourselves and to strive for achieving the will of our Higher Power. Our will didn't work.

I have taken all of the hurt that I have felt and that hurt I have cause to other people and made it into a ball and threw it away.

You will have noticed by now that humility plays a big part in this Narcotics Anonymous way of life. We take our inventory, we become ready to let God remove our defects of character, we humbly ask Him to remove our shortcomings. Not the other guy's but rather our own. This is our road to spiritual growth, to humbly and gradually change our own character, day by day. To gradually, carefully and simply pull ourselves out of the isolation and loneliness of hopeless drug addiction into this mainstream of useful fellowship. This does not happen by wishing for it, it requires action.

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(4) B – 8th Steps

1ST DRAFT

The last five steps of Narcotics Anonymous—the Eighth through the Twelfth—are the "get out and live" steps. ~~They are the ones that teach us how to manage life and deal with other people.~~ Just so, as the First, Second, and Third Steps give us the necessary tools to begin a clean life and the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, and Seventh Steps complete the complicated process of self-forgiveness and the beginning of new attitudes, the Eighth Step starts the procedure of forgiving other people, being forgiven by them, and learning how to live in the world as a drug-free human being.

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The point of the Eighth Step is willingness. Are we willing, if it is possible and practical, to make amends; to once, and for all, clear away the shadows of fear that our past holds for us?

The preceding Seven Steps looked pretty rough until we took the plunge and got into them. This one is no different. It seems hard now, but once we've done it we'll wonder why we didn't do it long ago.

Once again, we admit where we were at fault regardless of what the other person did to arouse our hostility--we admit that we hurt them, directly or indirectly, through some action, some lie, some broken promise, neglect or whatever it was.

This step is a good test of our new found humility.

We consult with our sponsors in this matter. Again, as in the Fourth Step, we do not want to become entangled in useless, dangerous self loathing. Our purpose is to achieve freedom from the guilt we have carried so far, without much pain so that we can look the world in the eye with neither aggressiveness nor fear.

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(4) B-8 8th Step.

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The Eighth Step is not easy; it demands a new kind of honesty about our relations with other people.

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We had to feel better internally before we could even bear to think about whom we had harmed, how we had harmed them, and exactly what harm we had caused. One of our difficulties in our addiction was the way we perceived ourselves.

Once again, we admit where we were at fault regardless of what the other person did to arouse our hostility--we admit that we hurt them, directly or indirectly, through some action, some lie some broken promise, neglect or whatever it was.

It will not make me a better person to judge the faults of another. The thing that will make me a better person is to clean up my own messes--relieve myself of my own guilt. This eighth step is a mighty stride away from a life dominated by guilt and remorse.

We need some real honesty before we can make an accurate list.

In preparing to make the Eighth Step list it is helpful to define harm. One definition of harm is physical or mental damage. Another definition is inflicting pain, suffering, or loss. The damage may be caused by something that is said or done and the harm resulting from these words or actions may be either intentional or unintentional on the part of the person who is inflicting the harm. The degrees of harm can run from making someone feel mentally uncomfortable to inflicting bodily injury or even death.

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D 8th Step

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We make our list, or take it from our Fourth Step and add to it anything we can think of and then we face that list honestly and openly and examine our hearts. Are we willing to make amends? In many cases we cannot do it, it is not possible nor practical in some instances. We may not know who it was we wronged in some cases. In other instances we might run the risk of involving a third person, some companion of our days of drug abuse who does not wish to be exposed. We do not have the right nor do we need for any moral reason to endanger that person.

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Just about anyone that comes into contact with an active addict risks being harmed. Many people mentioned their parents, spouses and children. Boyfriends, girlfriends, other addicts, casual acquaintances, co-workers, employers, teachers, landlords, and total strangers.

A problem many of us seem to have with the Eighth Step and the admission of the harm we did is the belief we were victims, not victimizers, in our addiction. Avoiding this rationalization is crucial to the Eighth Step,

John put it this way: "I had to think of disassociating what had been done to me and what I had done. I was forced to cut away all my justifications and all this idea of being a victim. The final difficulty in working the Eighth Step is separating it from the Ninth Step. Projecting about the Ninth Step can be a major obstacle both in making the list and in becoming willing. As Maggie said, "My sponsor told me not to even think about making the amends, but just to concentrate on exactly what the Eighth Step says which is to make a list and to become willing.

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(F) B-6 ~~Eighth Step~~

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"We ~~should~~ try and do this

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step as if there was no Ninth Step."

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The Eighth Step is actually an action step. And like all the action steps it offers immediate benefits. ~~Hank describes these benefits when he says~~, "The main thing this step does for ~~me~~ us to is it build~~s me to~~ the awareness that, little by little, ~~I am living through~~ we are gaining new attitudes about ~~myself, about~~ ourselves, and ~~how I deal~~ we deal with other people.

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(4) B-9th Step

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We want to get rid of our fear but we neither need nor wish to do so at the price of causing suffering to anyone else. It is very important that we take guidance from our sponsors or spiritual advisors in this matter. A very good approach, though certainly not the only approach to this task, is to take our list to our sponsor and let him or her help us set up a schedule or plan of amends.

We recommend turning over our legal problems to lawyers especially those who have actually helped someone in the program. Professional help is available to help us with our financial and medical problems. Part of learning to live is not to take on problems and responsibilities that we are ill equipped to handle.

In some cases we need to repay a sum of money or replace some object of value. This may be beyond our means. If it is, we can only proceed with direction.

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Timing is an essential part of this step. We should make amends when the opportunity presents itself, as long as to do so will not cause more harm than good.

when it gets to the point when we cannot hold the hurt in any longer, amends will be made.

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In some old relationship an unresolved conflict exists. We enter the old conflict and resolve it by our amends and thereby get out of any future antagonisms and ongoing resentments. These are the old tapes that would keep playing back as long as we lived. By making amends we create a lasting change in our lives, and We also We also beholdd the mysterious fact that instead of feeling knocked down and drained of energy, we feel relieved and sort of excited. 5

This step puts positive direction in your life concerning other people. All the years of using, destruction have put a negative attitude in others about you & it helps you deal with your guilt & others with their anger. Jan

In many instances we will need to go somewhere, ~~as they say, "with our hats in our hands" that is to say~~, humbly to ask forgiveness for some old wrong. Sometimes, this will turn out to be a joyous occasion when some old friend or relative proves very willing to let bygones be bygones and welcomes us back to the land of the living. However, some people are not so willing to let go of their bitterness, as we ourselves were once unwilling to let go of it. They may refuse to accept our apology; may refuse to hear us out or return our letters unopened. We must not fall into remorse over this for we have done the best we could.

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B-9 2nd Step

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~~There are some things we can make direct amends for, some we can only make~~
There are some things we can make direct amends for, some we can only make partial amends for, and some we can not make direct amends for at all.

In some instances, making amends would make certain people aware of things they knew nothing about, therefore causing unnecessary hurt, pain or anger. just to relieve my own guilt. The amends I make are mostly for me.

We can make amends by our actions. They don't always have to be verbal, ~~and~~ and we try to practice this whenever impossible to make verbal amends or the ~~time~~ right time has not yet come.

Staying clean is also an amend because we are no longer part of the problem, now we're part of recovery.

It is not in our power to go into the past and undo that which has been done. We can offer our amonds. If they are accepted, so much the better. If they are not, we have done what we could and we can walk away with a clear conscience. If the incident disturbs us, we get to our sponsors or to a meeting and share the experience. It is advisable to pray for those who are unable to forgive.

WHEN it CAME to MAKING AMENDS FOR All the things We Did. there WAS QUITE A Alot found. We HAD to KEEP OUR AMENDS in GENERAL. We REALY didnt want to BRING UP old PROBLEMS AND PAIN to LOVED ONE'S.

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In the progress of our ~~xxx~~ recovery we will be restored to sanity and part of sanity is effectively relating to others. We will less often view people as a threat to our security. Real security in our gut and in our cleanliness will replace the physical ache and mental confusion. We will want to address ourselves to these people with love and patience. Fear of relapse will make many of our most sincere wellwishers reluctant to accept our cleanliness as real. We must remember the pain they have known. In time many seeming miracles will occur. Many of us separated from their children succeed in reestablishing deep emotional bonds. Estranged wives or husbands may be dangerous to our recovery if they fit the category of old playmates. They will need to get us loaded to justify their sickness. If the relationship is real, it will survive. Reacceptance into the family of our birth is eventual. Clean and sober speaks for itself. Patience is the great method in this process. The unconditional love we experience as members of the program will rejuvenate our will to live and each positive move on our part will be matched by an unexpected opportunity.

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The benefit of this step is to be able to face people we have known with a clear conscience. By discovering and admitting our fault we work a miracle.

4-B-10

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Are we doing our best? Are we staying honest? Are we still growing or are we slipping back into the old fears and resentments? It is the purpose of the Tenth Step to answer these and similar questions.

Those defects of character which we found in the Fourth Step (and probably some of which we didn't see at the time) are deeply ingrained in our being.

Continueing to take personal inventory means ~~means~~ that we form a habit of looking at our selfs our attitudes, our actions, and our relationships on a regular basis. WE try to come up with honest evaluations and to put out more or less energy in certain areas ~~I am~~ WE ARE concerned with. It's very important to keep sharing with other people so that when you come up with a rationalization for seeing positive in a negative behavior we can be told about it when we can't be honest with ourselves. ~~Sometimes we are too personally~~

. Especially in times of stress, when we must endure hunder, anger, loneliness or weariness, we are vulnerable to the old ways of thinking and reacting.

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we need to deal with ourselves first realizing where we were wrong or on how maybe just what can I do to make things better, rather than to "take" others inventory" and forget about our own defects,

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This step keeps us growing and changing. It is easy after dealing with the past in the other nine steps to become complacent and to think we have it "all together." Although we have made strong changes in our lives having it all together is far from the truth. We need to keep looking at ourselves in each category in order to [illegible] keep old forms of behavior from creeping back in on us.

This highlights the preventative part of the Tenth Step. You ask yourself as you go through the day--especially if you find yourself becoming upset or uncomfortable, "Am I being sucked in by some old pattern of fear or resentment? Am I too tired? Too hungry? Is my thinking getting cloudy?

You can see what a great tool this is. It gives us a way of avoiding grief before we bring it on ourselves. It's a sort of vaccination against insanity--provided we use it on a continuing ~~daily~~ basis.

We have discussed the preventative side of the Tenth Step. The more we use it, the less we will need the corrective side. Sometimes we are going to revert a little and we are going to do things we ourselves disapprove of. When this happens the Tenth Step is there to keep us from slipping back into the shadow land of guilt,

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hard feelings and remorse. We examine ourselves on a daily basis. Did we cause someone harm? Do we need to make an amend? If we do, we take care of it as soon as possible. When these things are left undone, they have a way of festering like an infection. We get to our sponsor--we are honest, we take the indicated action, and we learn and grow from it.

Many of these things which, in the beginning, seem so difficult, prove to be our greatest sources of growth and strength. We do not do these things because we are altruistic. We do not apologize to the one we harmed out of any great compassion or natural inclination to be kind. We do it first and foremost because it is the only way we know for addicts of our type to change our basic characters and for us, like it or not, the law is, change or die. Not wishing to die, we try to change. At first, we pretty much "act as if" we believe in this new life. We are tolerant of others because resentment or impatience could kill us. Of course, as time goes by, we try to grow spiritually, so that our old ways of selfishness and fear may gradually be replaced with fellowship and love.

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when we first come into the program we are protected and guided by some kind of power greater th n ourselves. This we have set in motion by surrendering to ~~th3 program~~ 3rd Step and asking for help. The purpose of th eleventh step is to increase our awareness of that power and the ability to use it as a source of strength in our new lives.

Now ~~we're in N.A. and~~ we've been clean and sober for awhile and we're trying to work the steps of the N.A. program to the best of our ability and, though we usually don't notice it at first--we are finally beginning to get high!

Many of us really begin to appreciate this fact when we get into the Eleventh Step. For in the Eleventh Step the good life we've been practicing or pretending to believe so that we could stay away from drugs--suddenly it begins to come alive, to mean something. We find ourselves praying because it feels good, because it brings us peace and restores our confidence and courage. It helps us to live a life of love and stay away from that old life of fear and distrust. As we seek <u>our</u> God, our personal, private contact with God we begin to open up like a flower in the sun. We begin to see that God's love was there all the time, just waiting for us to accept it. Life finally begins to get sweet and good even though we still face all the heartaches and tragedies that are the lot of mankind.

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[redacted]

Clean
~~[illegible]~~ living is possible ~~as human beings~~ when we rely in a higher power on a daily basis to provide us spiritual progress. The 12-steps of <u>n</u>arcotics <u>a</u>nonymous are a progressive recovery process establishing in us normal living; the normal life of reliance in our higher power.

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In the Third Step we tried to turn our will and our life over to God. We renew this effort daily in the Eleventh Step.

Most of us rebel against this in the beginning. The old fears cry out, "My will be done." The first time we hear someone say, "Let go and let God," it sounds idiotic. "No!" we say,"if I let go I'll disappear or someone will take advantage of me." But it doesn't work out that way. What happens instead is that the more we improve our conscious contact with God via prayer and meditation, the more often we pause when doubtful and say, "God, I don't know what to do. Please show me which way to go," ~~the higher we get~~.

It's a fact. When we finally get our own selfish motives out of the way, even just once in awhile, and pray for guidance--really meaning it--even just once in awhile, we begin to find a peace beyond that of any drug. We begin to feel a calm joy not obtainable on any black market. We begin to experience an awareness and an empathy with other people that would never be possible under the influence of a drug.

A person who has realized their powerlessness and seen the o vision their H.P. has for them will see why we pray only for s knowledge of his will for us and the power to carry it out. Our deepest longings and recurent images of the kind of persons we'd like to be are only glimpses of God's will for us. Our perceptions are so limited we can't see to the end of things and when we place ourselves in the care of our ultimate authority, a loving God, it is our own real dreams that come true. Of course it's pretty easy to slip back into our old ways. We literally have to learn to maintain our new lives on a sp

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4-11-B

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spiritually sound basis to insure our continued growth and recovery. God as we of N.A. understand him, will not force His goodness on us but will wait until we ask. This is no cruelty. Enforced morality lacks the force that comes from our own choice. If God forced His

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The 11th step helps us in the face of a problem to be aware of God. The underlying principle of this 11th step is God consciousness.

When we pray ~~for knowledge of God's will for us and the power to carry that out~~--a remarkable thing happens; we find the means, the ways and the energies to perform tasks far beyond our capabilities. By the apparent surrender of our own power, we gain a far mightier power that will see us through every conceivable trial or trouble so long as we keep faith and renew it through daily prayer.

Our efforts have produced in us, many times, a feeling of peace and serenity that we have never experienced before.

We know that in doing God's will our lives will be fulfilled.

We try to avoid asking for specific things. It's hard because we're so sure that we know what's right for us. We now know if we pray to do God's will, we will receive what's best for us.

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4-B-12

Step 12

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The idea of a spiritual awakening ~~may seem like nonsense or words by a newcomer but the proof is in the pudding.~~ Although ~~it~~ takes many different forms in the many different personalities we find in N.A., ~~the spiritual~~ this awakening does have some things in common throughout the fellowship. Life takes on a new meaning, a new joy, a quality of being good and worthwhile, which to most of us, was as alien as another planet prior to our working this program. We become spiritually refreshed and are glad to be alive.

Our suffering has cleaned us of some of our illusions. In our own time we have been guided to a new life and place in the world and in our hearts where things seem to fit and work ~~--~~ for a change.

This great step is to be proceded by the working of the proceding 11. There are those of us who tryed to work and stay clean off step 12 without 2"having had a spiritual awakenig, and as a result, are now dead, ~~the dope killed them~~. The ones who continue to "practice these principles in all their affairs tell us that this is the most wonerful thing one can know. The journey and the journeys end. A feeling of gratitude.

Usually, by the time we achieve this state of mind, no one has to tell us to share our new life with the still-suffering addict; we are more than eager to help that person because by this time we recognize that helping others--giving away that which has been given to us is our best possible insurance against a "slip" or a return to the vague, tortured existence of a practicing drug addict.

We call it "carrying the message" and we do it in any number of ways.

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The first way in which we carry the message is by staying clean ~~and sober~~ with the help of God and the N.A. program. Our new way of life speaks for itself better than our words ever could. People see us on the street. They remember us as furtive, frightened lookers. They see us gradually come alive; see the grayness and fear leave our faces; see a spring come into our step and a twinkle come into our eyes. The message is meaningless unless we live it. If we do it, we give it more meaning with our lives than our words ever can.

Learning the art of helping others when it is appropriate without creating resentments is a marvelous benefit of the program.

Remarkably our twelve steps guide us from a state of humiliation and despair to a state wherin we are able to act as instruments of God's will. We receive the gift of being able to help fellow suffering addicts when no one else can. No greater change of personality is possible ~~[illegible]~~ We see it happening among us everyday. This miraculous hundred and eighty degree change is accepted as a commonplace. ~~the spiritual awakening~~ evidence of spiritual awakening.

We attend the meetings and make ourselves visible and available to serve the fellowship. We give freely and gratefully of our time, our services, ~~our money~~, and our experience in ~~the~~ service to our fellows. We do not shirk when called upon to practice these principles, because we know that the more eagerly we wade in and work to stay clean, ~~and sober,~~ the higher we're going to get--or--to put it another way, the richer our spiritual awakening will become.

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~~[illegible]~~g others works. Their is no one putting on N.A.

We do these things because they are the things that grant the new lives we are ~~seeking~~. enjoying.

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In the 12th Step is the spiritual principle of giving away the N.A. message of recovery in order to keep it. This is like reaping what we sow. An addict by trying to sow cleanliness in others may by God's grace reap cleanliness. The old habit of using drugs is replaced by the new habit of not using and helping others to get clean.

NOT Even a member with one week in the N.A. Fellowship can turn to a newcomer and say, "Easy does it."

Lord make me an instrument, we may say, as we climb in the car to help some one. but we dont go it alone. As in all else we don't have to be alone. It is just a matter of finding someone to go with you on this call to carry the message to a suffering addict. We do not set ourselves up as God. ~~We humbly take to the task in love and gratitude giving what was so freely given to us.~~ We are gratful to have been set free and for the opportunity ~~to help~~ To be a real part of God. That is why it is spiritual. We get to become the grace of God in action. It is a privilege and an honor to go out on a 12 step call. The privilege of wanting to serve our NA group is given to only ~~about 1% of the members~~ a few. Those of us who do service work are the luckiest people on Gods earth. We, who have been in the pits of dispair, now strive to help other people to find a new and better way to live.

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~~Especially~~ When we are asked to help newcomers whether they are de-toxifying [redacted] or just beginning to learn the principles of the N.A. program--~~whether he be young or old, of our race or some other race or creed~~--we will do what we can to make the newcomers aware of what the program offers and we will try to make the ~~newcomers~~ Them feel at home. Experience shows that the best way to accomplish these ends is to listen carefully to what they want to do about their problems share ~~with them~~ our own experience, strength and hope, [redacted] and accompany them to their first meeting.

4-B-12

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The selfless service that comes from such work is the very principle standing just behind the surface of step 12. It is ~~indeed the~~ clearness of awareness of Gods grace working ~~through us~~ that provides so much of what the addict out there needs. Just as the grace of a loveing God who we had turned our backs on was brought to us, ~~in human form~~ ~~step 12~~ now we have a chance to extend the grace ~~of god~~ to others. Just one 12th step call of this nature can make a life ~~a~~ times worth while. And thier are plenty of such opportunities for those of us in NA.

We have been blessed with the appertunity to carry the message to a place where there was very little hope; The addict who still suffers

The 12th Step also suggests that we practice these principles in all of our affairs. As long as we stay clean and ~~work~~ live these principles, we are doing 12-Step work. We are actually attracting people to us and the N.A. program by our example of cleanliness.

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We no longer wish to partisipate in a the problem. We now wish to serve ~~the solution, which is~~ God as we understand him. Humbly in this manner do we renew our vow to turn our wills and lives over to the care of God. ~~as we understand it~~. Even if we have no such understanding we will aquire it through seeing others recover.

They will show that God is loving, they will show his grace, they will show us more than we ever dreamed of knowing. the steps do not end here they are just new beginning.